CHAPTER 95

The Five Rulers of the Nativity

FINAL SUMMARY

> For the divine Mind is diffused throughout the whole body of the universe as in a circle, now outside, now inside, and rules and orders all things.—FIRMICUS MATERNUS.[1]

IN AN INTEGRATED VIEW OF THE COSMOS WHERE ABOVE AND BELOW coexist in one unified field, the arrangement of planets in the solar system at a particular moment mirrors the structure of the nativity at the time of birth. The planets in the cosmos can be correlated with the centers of consciousness within the human psyche. This is not a modern innovation. Valens himself wrote: "the Sun is the soul, the light of the mind".[2]

Each planet has its own individual function in manifesting a certain component of a person's essence and destiny. Some planets also play extra roles and carry additional responsibilities within the broader context of a person's life as a whole. These planets are the Rulers of the Nativity. We have investigated five offices that oversee the management of the life in terms of (1) overall happiness and success, (2) material fortune and well-being, (3) eminence and support from one's community, (4) vitality and life force, and (5) guidance towards spiritual liberation from earthly constraints.

These five offices can be held by five different planets, or one planet can hold multiple roles. In the latter case, that planet would wield considerable power. Porphyry indicated that if the roles of the *Oikodespotēs* and *Kurios* were held by the same planet, it signified an outstanding destiny.

It is illuminating to identify which planets in a given chart have the ultimate authority for overseeing and governing a person's life. Is the responsibility and power shared by many, or is it concentrated among just a few? Which planets are these? And what are the individual agendas that they carry out alongside or even

1 *Mathesis* 1.5.10 (trans. RHYS BRAM).
2 VALENS, *Anthology* 1.1.